



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Covenant Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://covenantcs.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Covenant Classical Christian School (SC 29204) presents a robust CLASSICAL Christian education model that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a Christ-centered, classical approach anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), commitment to Great Books and Western civilization-informed study, rigorous yet contemplative pedagogy (Scholé), and a close partnership with families and the broader church community. Across six categories—Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community—the school exhibits core classical indicators: explicit theology integrated with the curriculum; formation of virtue and wisdom as telos; a liberal-arts-inflected, Great-Books-oriented curriculum; Socratic/seminar- and rhetoric-linked pedagogy; a faculty described as mentors and living exemplars; and a strong emphasis on parental partnership and community involvement. Evidence from Covenant's site, admissions materials, curriculum descriptions, and faculty pages consistently shows these features, with explicit references to grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, senior theses, and a mission to form steadfast disciples, scholars, and citizens. Consequently, the aggregation of signals across the six categories supports a primary classification of CLASSICAL for Covenant Classical Christian School. Negative signals typically associated with non-classical approaches (e.g., exclusive emphasis on job readiness, project-based-only pedagogy, or secularized curricula) are largely absent in the public materials analyzed.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** explicit articulation that education is Christ-centered and anchored in Scripture; theological framing pervades the curriculum; God's Word at the center; theology integrated with disciplines. Positive signals include references to Scripture-centered learning, theology as a guiding force, and liturgical/catechetical framing in the broader classical Christian tradition. Keyword analysis: Strong presence of positive indicators (truth/beauty/goodness in a theologically-infused system; theology; liturgy; reverence; wonder). Minimal to no negative indicators found in the materials. Why this rating: The school situates all learning within a theologically informed framework, with explicit statements about a Christ-centered, biblically grounded education and integrated theology across subjects. This matches the Positive Keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and shows clear alignment with the classical-education ideal here.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** mission statements emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom; telos includes formation of character, virtue, and human excellence; explicit aim to form disciples and citizens, not merely prepare for a career; discussion of liberal paideia and "great conversation." Keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, scholé, classical mission, great conversation; negligible evidence of a predominant workforce- or career-mentality in public-facing materials. Why this rating: Covenant presents education as formation and cultivation of virtue/wisdom—precisely the Element 2 signals for a classical telos. The presence of dual-enrollment/career pathways is framed within a larger formation context rather than primary emphasis, reinforcing CLASSICAL.

-
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: explicit focus on the liberal-arts framework; grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation; Western Civilization; Latin; Biblical Greek; ancient history and literature; integration across history and literature; senior theses and classical diplomas; Great Ideas of Western Civilization I & II; Theology integrated with curriculum. Keyword analysis: High presence of positive indicators (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books/Great Conversation; Western Civilization; Latin/Greek; history integrated with literature; purpose of study as formation through canonical texts). No strong signals of non-classical curricula (e.g., “social studies-centric history” or STEM-first framing) in public materials. Why this rating: The curriculum is squarely built around the Trivium, Great Books, and classical humanities, with explicit disciplines, canonical texts, and integrated history/poetry/literature—central to CLASSICAL.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: reference to grammar/logic/rhetoric pedagogy; lower grades include memory work, singing, and chant; upper grades include Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; opportunities for public speaking and senior theses; contemplative/restful elements implied via scholé. Keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Socratic dialogue, dialectic, memorization/recitation, rhetoric, seminars, and contemplation/wonder; limited or no presence of consistent negative signals such as sole project-based or constructivist approaches. Why this rating: The pedagogy explicitly blends contemplative/restful dimensions (Scholé) with Socratic and rhetoric-based instruction, a hallmark of classical pedagogy. The explicit inclusion of memory work and chant in the lower grades also aligns with the classical model. This justifies CLASSICAL.
 - Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: public materials describe faculty as highly qualified, biblically grounded, and living examples of virtue; faculty are portrayed as mentors in a “living curriculum” and as part of a collegial community; emphasis on professional development and long-tenured faculty. Keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, clergy/faith-informed faculty, collegial culture. Negative indicators (if any) are not evident in the public-facing materials. Why this rating: The school emphasizes faculty as moral exemplars and curricular guides, consistent with classical-category norms (mentor-teacher as central to formation). This supports CLASSICAL.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: explicit emphasis on partnering with parents; parents as co-teachers; programs and book/gatherings for parent formation; open-campus ethos and opportunities to visit; family-involved service projects and church/community partnerships are showcased. Keyword analysis: Positive indicators include parent partnership, co-educators, family involvement, home-school alignment, parent formation, open campus, community engagement. Negative signals are not evident in the public-facing materials. Why this rating: Covenant positions parents as active collaborators in the classical paideia, aligning with the Six Elements’ expectations for Parent/Community engagement. This supports CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Across all six categories Covenant CCCS demonstrates the core signals of classical Christian education: a theologically integrated liberal-arts curriculum; emphasis on the Trivium; Great Books/Great Conversation; a pedagogy combining contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) with Socratic and rhetorical methods; a living, virtue-oriented faculty; and a robust partnership with families and the church community. Public-facing materials consistently foreground truth/goodness/beauty in a biblically grounded framework, with formation as telos and a commitment to human flourishing through classical means. No category shows the predominant signals of not-classical practices, and the weight of explicit classical indicators is high. This places Covenant CCCS firmly in CLASSICAL territory according to the Six Essential Elements rubric.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable for a CLASSICAL determination in this instance. If one insisted on a needle, it would be to further codify and publicly document explicit liturgical/community practices (beyond the theological integration) to more clearly display liturgical rhythms and communal worship as a formal, ongoing element of daily schooling, which could further strengthen Element 1 in a more liturgical sense. However, this is not a necessary change given the current CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.